

Saturday, 23 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 20°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

24° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

22° 15°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

The government is set to review the sentences given to three teenage boys involved in the rape of two girls.

The boys did not receive custodial sentences for their roles in the crime. This decision has sparked public debate and prompted the review by the government.

JUSTICE · UK

2

An ongoing investigation involving the former prince could now extend to include sexual misconduct allegations.

He was initially arrested back in February on suspicion of misconduct in public office. This potential expansion of the inquiry adds a new dimension to the case.

ROYAL · UK

3

A cafe owner has expressed disappointment following a visit from Reform UK, who then hit back at the criticism.

The owner claimed Reform UK's visit to their establishment was "politically influenced". Reform UK has since responded to these claims, dismissing the allegations.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Fans of 'Emily in Paris' should prepare for its farewell, as Netflix confirms the show will conclude after its upcoming sixth season.**

Star Lily Collins announced that the popular series is set to wrap up. Viewers will get one more chance to follow Emily's adventures in the French capital.

TV · UPCOMING

2 **Channel 4 may face scrutiny in the coming weeks following new allegations from former participants of 'Married at First Sight UK'.**

Three women who took part in the programme have made claims against the show. This could prompt a closer look at reality TV welfare practices going forward.

TV · THIS WEEK

3 **With the UK's recent Eurovision struggles, the BBC is reportedly taking a hard look at its approach for the 2027 contest.**

After several years of disappointing results, there's a push to re-evaluate how the UK selects its entries. Fans are hoping for a new strategy to improve future performances.

MUSIC · 2027

On the schedule

- 1 England manager Thomas Tuchel has been explaining his decisions for the upcoming World Cup squad selections.**
Tuchel clarified that his focus isn't solely on the 26 most talented players. He's looking for the right balance for the tournament squad.
FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP
- 2 British tennis player Felix Gill will need to wait a bit longer for his Grand Slam singles debut after a defeat in French Open qualifying.**
Gill fell at the final hurdle, missing out on a spot in the main draw. It was a tough loss, but he'll be back for future tournaments.
TENNIS · UK
- 3 With Pep Guardiola set to depart Manchester City, we're looking back at the key matches that defined his incredible Premier League title wins.**
Guardiola is preparing to leave the club after a decade of success. His tenure has seen City dominate the Premier League.
FOOTBALL · PREMIER LEAGUE
- 4 Pep Guardiola has explained his decision to leave Manchester City at the end of the season, citing the need for fresh energy.**
Guardiola feels the club would benefit from a new manager and a different approach. He's looking forward to a new challenge after his successful time at City.
FOOTBALL · PREMIER LEAGUE

Quick hits

- 1 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 2 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.
- 3 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 4 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 5 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.
- 6 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 7 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** 69% of Brits do THIS as soon as they get in from work. What?

ANSWER: TAKE THEIR TROUSERS OFF AND PUT PYJAMA BOTTOMS ON.
- Q** 39% of us have done THIS in a supermarket trolley aisle. What?

ANSWER: HAD A FULL DOMESTIC ARGUMENT.

TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says 30% of us have a 'forever favourite' meal we'd be happy eating every day.**
Talk-back: what's yours? And could you really eat it every day?
- **Researchers say the average person has 27 unread voicemails. We're voicemail-phobic.**
Talk-back: when did you last actually listen to one? And who left it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£10.75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£10.75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The plastic bits on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Penguins propose to their mates by giving them a pebble.
- Strawberries aren't actually berries, but bananas, watermelons and pumpkins are.
- Cats have a special collarbone that lets them always land on their feet — usually.
- The word 'set' has the most definitions of any word in the English language — 430.
- The longest English word without a vowel is 'rhythms'.
- Ketchup was sold in the 1830s as medicine.
- Hippos secrete their own natural sunscreen — a reddish, oily substance.

On this day

Day 143 of the year, 222 days left in 2026. Today Aromanian National Day; Christian feast day: Aaron the Illustrious (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Desiderius of Vienne; Christian feast day: Giovanni Battista de' Rossi. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1933 — Joan Collins, English actress
- 1977 — Richard Ayoade, British actor, director and writer
- 1980 — Chris Gethard, American actor, comedian and writer
- 1986 — Ryan Coogler, American film director and screenwriter
- 1967 — Philip Selway, English musician
- 1954 — Gerry Armstrong, Northern Irish international footballer
- 1966 — H. Jon Benjamin, American actor, comedian, writer, and producer
- 1941 — Zalman King, American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2012)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — A Tupolev Tu-144 crashes near the Russian town of Yegoryevsk, killing two.
- 2013 — A freeway bridge carrying Interstate 5 over the Skagit River collapses in Mount Vernon, Washington.
- 1971 — Seventy-eight people are killed when Aviogenex Flight 130 crashes on approach to Rijeka Airport in present-day Rijeka, Croatia (then the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia).

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2013 — A freeway bridge carrying Interstate 5 over the Skagit River collapses in Mount Vernon, Washington.
- 1992 — Italy's most prominent anti-mafia judge Giovanni Falcone, his wife and three body guards are killed by the Corleonesi clan with a half-ton bomb near Capaci, Sicily. His friend and colleague Paolo Borsellino will be assassinated less than two months later, making 1992 a turning...

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1980 — The Shining, the psychological horror film directed by Stanley Kubrick, is premiered on 10 screens in New York City and Los Angeles on the Memorial Day weekend.

- 1949 — Cold War: The Western occupying powers approve the Basic Law and establish a new German state, the Federal Republic of Germany.
- 1945 — World War II: Heinrich Himmler, head of the Schutzstaffel, commits suicide while in Allied custody.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 144 of the year, 221 days left in 2026. Today Aldersgate Day/Wesley Day (Methodism); Battle of Pichincha Day (Ecuador); Bermuda Day (Bermuda), celebrated on the nearest weekday if May 24 falls on the weekend.; Christian feast day: Anna Pak Agi (one of The Korean Martyrs). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — G-Eazy, American rapper
- 1949 — Jim Broadbent, English actor
- 1967 — Heavy D, Jamaican-American rapper, producer, and actor (died 2011)
- 1947 — Waddy Wachtel, American guitarist, singer-songwriter, and record producer
- 1965 — John C. Reilly, American actor
- 1988 — Billy Gilman, American musician
- 1937 — Archie Shepp, American saxophonist and composer
- 1986 — Mark Ballas, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, dancer, and actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1999 — The International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia in The Hague, Netherlands indicts Slobodan Milošević and four others for war crimes and crimes against humanity committed in Kosovo.
- 1981 — Ecuadorian president Jaime Roldós Aguilera, his wife, and his presidential committee die in an aircraft accident while travelling from Quito to Zapotillo minutes after the president gave a famous speech regarding the 24 de mayo anniversary of the Battle of Pichincha.
- 2014 — A 6.4 magnitude earthquake occurs in the Aegean Sea between Greece and Turkey, injuring 324 people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — The first Eurovision Song Contest is held in Lugano, Switzerland.
- 2014 — At least three people are killed in a shooting at Brussels' Jewish Museum of Belgium.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		